

What Do the Lights on Your ONT Mean? Complete ONT Light Guide

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The lights on your ONT provide a quick status check of your fiber internet connection. In most cases, **a solid Power light, a solid PON light and an off LOS light indicate a healthy fiber connection**. A red or blinking LOS light usually means the ONT is not receiving an optical signal, while the LAN light shows whether the ONT is connected to your router or another device.

Understanding these indicators can turn many internet problems into a two-minute diagnosis and help you determine whether the issue is with your fiber line, ONT, router or home Wi-Fi network.

Note: LED names, colors and blinking patterns can vary slightly depending on the ONT manufacturer, model and ISP configuration. The patterns below represent common fiber ONTs. Always follow your ISP’s or device manufacturer’s guidance when the indicators on your ONT behave differently.

ONT Lights Meaning at a Glance

ONT Light	Normal State	Problem State	What It Usually Means
Power / PWR	Solid green	Off	ONT is receiving power
PON	Solid green	Blinking or off	ONT registration with the fiber network
LOS	Off	Red or blinking red	Loss of optical signal

LAN / Ethernet	Solid or blinking	Off	Connection between ONT and router/device
Internet / WAN	Usually green or blinking	Off or abnormal indicator	Internet session or connectivity status
Phone / POTS	Usually solid when registered	Off	Landline service status

The exact behavior of some indicators, particularly **Internet, WAN, LAN and Phone**, can differ between ONT models.

What Is an ONT?

An **ONT**, or [Optical Network Terminal](#), is the device that terminates the fiber optic connection at your premises and converts the optical signal into a connection that your router, computer or other network equipment can use.

In a typical fiber-to-the-home setup, the connection works like this:

The LED indicators on the ONT help show the status of different parts of this connection. This makes them one of the fastest ways to identify where a connectivity problem may be occurring.

What Each Light on Your ONT Means

1. Power / PWR Light

The Power light indicates whether the ONT is receiving electricity.

- **Solid green:** The ONT is powered on and operating.
- **Off:** The ONT may not be receiving power.

Check:

- The ONT power adapter
- The wall socket
- Any extension board being used

- Your UPS or backup power system, if installed

If the ONT remains off despite a confirmed working power source, the adapter or device may need inspection.

2. PON Light

PON stands for **Passive Optical Network**.

The PON light generally indicates whether your ONT has successfully connected and registered with your [ISP's fiber network](#).

- **Solid green:** The ONT is usually registered with the network and receiving the expected optical connection.
- **Blinking:** The ONT may be attempting to establish or complete network registration.
- **Off:** The ONT may not be registered or may not have a usable optical connection.

If the PON light continues blinking for several minutes after the ONT starts, check the LOS indicator. A red LOS light alongside an inactive PON light often points to an optical signal problem.

3. LOS Light

LOS stands for **Loss of Signal**.

This is one of the most important ONT lights for diagnosing a fiber connection problem.

- **Off:** This is normally the expected state. The ONT is receiving an optical signal.
- **Red or blinking red:** The ONT is not receiving a usable optical signal from the fiber network.

Possible causes include:

- A disconnected fiber cable
- A damaged fiber cable
- A fiber cable bent too sharply
- A loose optical connection
- An upstream fiber fault
- Fiber damage caused by construction or roadwork
- A problem elsewhere in the ISP's optical network

A red LOS light normally cannot be resolved by changing Wi-Fi settings or restarting your router because the problem occurs before the internet connection reaches your home network.

Avoid repeatedly removing or cleaning the fiber connector yourself. Fiber connectors and cable ends are sensitive and can be damaged or contaminated if handled incorrectly.

4. LAN / Ethernet Light

The LAN light shows the status of the wired Ethernet connection between the ONT and your router, computer or other network device.

- **Solid or blinking:** An Ethernet link is established. Blinking usually indicates network activity.
- **Off:** There may be no active Ethernet connection.

Check:

- Whether the Ethernet cable is securely connected
- The Ethernet port on the ONT
- The WAN or Internet port on your router
- Whether the Ethernet cable is damaged

Trying another Ethernet cable or port can help isolate the problem.

Because LED colors and link-speed indicators vary between manufacturers, do not rely on a specific LAN light color alone to determine your connection speed.

5. Internet / WAN Light

Some ONTs have a separate **Internet** or **WAN** indicator.

Depending on how your ISP configures the ONT, this light may represent the status of the internet connection, IP session or data activity.

- **Green or blinking:** Internet connectivity or traffic may be active.
- **Off or displaying an abnormal state:** There may be an internet session, configuration or authentication problem.

Because this indicator varies significantly between ONT models and ISP configurations, check the PON and LOS lights first when diagnosing a connection issue.

6. Phone / POTS Light

This indicator is relevant when your fiber connection also includes a landline service.

POTS stands for **Plain Old Telephone Service**.

- **Solid or active:** The phone service is generally registered.
- **Off:** The phone service may be inactive, unregistered or unavailable.

The exact behavior depends on the ONT and your ISP's voice service configuration.

What Should Normal ONT Lights Look Like?

On many healthy fiber internet connections, the expected pattern is:

- **Power:** Solid green
- **PON:** Solid green
- **LOS:** Off
- **LAN:** Solid or blinking when connected to a router
- **Internet/WAN:** Active where applicable

The most important combination to remember is:

Power ON + PON Solid + LOS Off

This generally indicates that the ONT has power and is connected to the fiber network.

If this pattern appears but your internet is still not working properly, the problem may be with:

- Your router
- Ethernet cabling
- Wi-Fi coverage
- Device settings
- Internet configuration
- An ISP-side issue that does not interrupt the optical signal

How to Read Common ONT Light Combinations

Looking at multiple ONT lights together often provides a more accurate diagnosis than checking one light in isolation.

1. Power Green + PON Green + LOS Off

This usually indicates a healthy optical connection.

If the internet is still not working, check:

1. LAN connection between the ONT and router
2. Router status
3. Wi-Fi connectivity
4. Ethernet cables
5. Whether the problem affects one device or all devices

The fiber signal itself is less likely to be the cause.

2. Power Green + LOS Red + PON Off

This usually means the ONT has power but is not receiving a usable optical signal.

Possible causes include:

- Disconnected fiber
- Damaged fiber cable
- Excessive cable bending
- Fiber cut outside the premises
- Upstream optical network fault

3. PON Blinking + LOS Off

The ONT may be attempting to register or establish connectivity with the fiber network.

After restarting the ONT, allow it several minutes to reconnect.

If the PON light continues blinking and internet service does not return, contact your ISP for further diagnosis.

4. PON Green + LAN Off

The ONT may have a healthy fiber connection but no active Ethernet link to the router.

Check:

1. The Ethernet cable at both ends
2. The ONT LAN port

3. The router's WAN or Internet port
4. Another Ethernet cable
5. Another available Ethernet port, where supported

5. Power Green + PON Green + LOS Off but No Internet

This is an important diagnostic pattern.

The optical connection appears healthy, so the issue may be occurring after the fiber reaches the ONT.

Possible causes include:

- Router malfunction
- Ethernet cable issue
- Internet session or configuration problem
- Temporary ISP-side service issue
- Wi-Fi problem rather than an internet connection problem

Restart the router first. If the issue continues across multiple devices, contact your ISP.

6. All ONT Lights Are Off

The ONT is most likely not receiving power.

Check:

- Power adapter
- Power socket
- Extension board
- UPS
- Electricity supply

During load shedding, the ONT will switch off unless it has a backup power source.

When Should You Restart Your ONT?

Restarting the ONT can help with some temporary connectivity and registration issues.

To restart it safely:

1. Disconnect the ONT from its power source.
2. Wait approximately 60 seconds.
3. Reconnect the power.
4. Allow a few minutes for the ONT to start and reconnect.
5. Check the Power, PON and LOS indicators.

A healthy connection will commonly return to:

- Power: On
- PON: Solid
- LOS: Off

Avoid repeatedly restarting the ONT within a short period.

A restart is also unlikely to solve a persistent red LOS light because the underlying problem is usually related to the optical signal.

How Load Shedding Affects Your ONT

Load shedding creates an additional connectivity challenge for fiber users in Pakistan.

Although fiber optic cables themselves do not require electricity inside your home to carry an optical signal, the equipment used to access that connection does.

Your:

- ONT
- Wi-Fi router

both require electrical power.

This means the fiber network may still be operational, but your internet connection will stop if the ONT and router switch off during a power outage.

A suitable backup power solution for both the ONT and router can help maintain internet access during shorter power outages, provided the ISP's network in the area also remains operational.

After electricity returns, most ONTs reconnect automatically. Allow the ONT a few minutes to restore its connection before restarting it manually.

Final Thoughts

Your ONT lights provide one of the fastest ways to understand what is happening with your fiber internet connection.

Instead of restarting every device immediately, read the ONT lights first. They can help you identify which part of the connection needs attention and whether the issue can be checked at home or requires ISP support.

New to fiber internet? Our guide to [fiber optic internet](#) explains how the fiber cable, ONT and Wi-Fi router work together from installation to activation.

Frequently Asked Questions

Can a red LOS light fix itself?

A temporary network interruption may clear without intervention, but a persistent red LOS light usually means the ONT is not receiving a usable optical signal. If the light remains red, contact your ISP.

Why is my PON light blinking while LOS is off?

The ONT may be attempting to register with the fiber network. Allow several minutes after startup. If the PON light does not become stable and internet service remains unavailable, contact your ISP.

Why is PON green but I still have no internet?

A green PON light generally suggests the optical connection is established. The problem may instead involve the router, Ethernet cable, internet configuration, Wi-Fi network or another ISP-side service issue.

Should I unplug the fiber cable from my ONT?

Avoid removing the optical fiber connector unless your ISP specifically instructs you to do so. Fiber connectors are sensitive and can be damaged or contaminated through unnecessary handling.

Can an ONT work during load shedding?

Yes, provided the ONT and router have a suitable backup power source and your ISP's network remains operational during the outage.

Is an ONT the same as a Wi-Fi router?

No. The ONT terminates the fiber optic connection and converts the optical signal for use by your network. The router distributes that connection to devices through Wi-Fi or Ethernet. Some devices may combine multiple networking functions, depending on the ISP setup.

Can a faulty ONT cause slow internet?

It is possible, but slow internet is often caused by Wi-Fi interference, router limitations, device congestion or other network factors. A wired speed test can help determine whether the problem is related to Wi-Fi or the internet connection itself.

How long does an ONT take to reconnect after restarting?

Many ONTs reconnect within a few minutes, although the exact time varies by device and network. If the PON light does not stabilize after several minutes or the LOS light remains red, contact your ISP.